

Psalms 67

Let the Nations Praise Thee

God be merciful unto us, and bless us

KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *God be merciful unto us, and bless us; and cause his face to shine upon us; Selah.*
- 2 *That thy way may be known upon earth, thy saving health among all nations.*
- 3 *Let the people praise thee, O God; let all the people praise thee.*
- 4 *O let the nations be glad and sing for joy: for thou shalt judge the people righteously, and govern the nations upon earth. Selah.*
- 5 *Let the people praise thee, O God; let all the people praise thee.*
- 6 *Then shall the earth yield her increase; and God, even our own God, shall bless us.*
- 7 *God shall bless us; and all the ends of the earth shall fear him.*

2 · CONTEXT

A brief harvest thanksgiving with strong missionary breadth, echoing the Aaronic blessing (Num 6:24–26) in its opening line and repeatedly calling all peoples and nations to praise God. Henry reads it as showing Israel's blessing was always meant to overflow toward "all the ends of the earth," not remain self-contained.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-3

"God be merciful unto us, and bless us... That thy way may be known upon earth, thy saving health among all nations. Let the people praise thee, O God; let all the people praise thee." National blessing is explicitly requested for the sake of global witness, not mere comfort.

Verse 4-7

"O let the nations be glad, and sing for joy: for thou shalt judge the people righteously... Then shall the earth yield her increase; and God, even our own God, shall bless us... and all the ends of the earth shall fear him." Harvest abundance and universal reverence are woven together as evidence of God's righteous, global governance.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Personal and national blessing exist to make God's "way" and "saving health" known to all nations—harvest and gladness are not ends in themselves but occasions for the whole earth to fear and praise the God who governs righteously.

Application for life today.

When you experience blessing, ask how it might make God's "way" known beyond yourself, not stop with private gratitude. Pray specifically for "the nations" and "all the people" to be glad in God, widening intercession beyond personal or local concerns. Let increase in your own life become a testimony point toward God's righteous governance, not just personal comfort.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no "right length" answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. How might a current blessing in your life become a way to make God's "saving health" known to others?

2. What would it look like to pray specifically, as this psalm does, for "all the nations" rather than only your own concerns?

3. How does connecting harvest and increase with worldwide praise (vv. 6–7) change how you view material blessing?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).